PAYAM RAZI

Filmmaker | Editor | Content Creator

Prague, Czech Republic

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PROFILE

Filmmaker, editor and content creator with more than 15 years of experience across independent cinema, international media and audiovisual production. Combines editorial experience at Radio Free Europe / Radio Liberty with hands-on work writing, directing and editing films, documentaries, radio programmes and digital content. Experienced in storytelling, audio and video editing, multilingual production and taking projects from concept through final delivery.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Radio Free Europe / Radio Liberty - Radio Farda

Editor in Chief - Music | 2008 - 2019

- Produced and edited radio and multimedia content for the Persian Service, including interviews, cultural programming and audio features.
- Worked closely with journalists, editors, presenters and technical teams in an international newsroom.
- Managed editorial schedules and production workflows, maintaining accuracy, consistency and delivery under daily broadcast deadlines.
- Developed editorial concepts and shaped cultural and social subjects into clear, accessible stories.
- Produced English-language audio programmes and podcasts about Iranian musicians, artists and cultural figures living in exile.

Independent Filmmaker, Editor & Creative Producer | 2006 - Present

- Write, direct, produce and edit narrative films, documentaries and promotional audiovisual projects, developing work from initial concept through final delivery.
- Develop scripts, storyboards and narrative concepts; collaborate with producers on creative development, production planning and editorial decisions.
- Direct international cast and crew, coordinating creative work across writing, cinematography, editing, sound and post-production.
- Edit short- and long-form work with a focus on narrative structure, pacing, emotional engagement and visual storytelling.
- Work with multilingual footage, interviews and archival material, shaping coherent stories across fiction and documentary formats.
- Manage picture editing, subtitle preparation and media organization; coordinate sound, colour and VFX work with post-production specialists.
- Prepare project files, clean and subtitled versions, and final delivery materials for production, distribution and festival requirements.

SELECTED FILMS

Sima Needs to Die | Feature Film, 2026

Writer / Director / Editor

Debut feature, co-written, directed, co-produced and edited from script through final delivery. Explores exile, political struggle and the meaning of homeland.

Norma | Short Film, 2024

Writer / Director / Editor

Short film screened at dozens of festivals, combining strong storytelling with a range of technical filmmaking skills.

Portfolio: vimeo.com/payamrazi | Additional filmography available upon request.

PAYAM RAZI | Filmmaker, Editor & Content Creator

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Screenshot Film House, Prague

Founder & Managing Director | 2019 - 2023

- Founded and operated an independent arthouse cinema and cultural space serving international audiences.
- Curated film programmes, screenings, workshops and special events focused on independent and international cinema.
- Created and programmed “Czechs Through the Lens,” a two-month programme showcasing fifty contemporary Czech and Slovak filmmakers.
- Produced promotional materials and audience engagement campaigns supporting screenings and cultural events.
- Oversaw programming, budgets, scheduling and daily operations; coordinated filmmakers, technical teams and cultural partners.

PRODUCTION & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Editing: Adobe Premiere Pro - Advanced; DaVinci Resolve - Editing and post-production workflow
Motion graphics: Adobe After Effects - Proficient
Additional software: Adobe Audition, Adobe Photoshop
Post-production: Story and interview editing, audio editing, sound-image integration, subtitle preparation, multilingual versioning, and colour, sound and VFX coordination
Production: Script development, storyboarding, creative producing, production planning and post-production supervision
Workflow: Google Workspace, media and archive management, scheduling, quality control and final delivery

INDUSTRY PARTICIPATION

Berlinale Talents | TorinoFilmLab (TFL Next) | Cannes Marché du Film | IDFA

EDUCATION

FAMU International, Prague
Film Directing Programme | 2006

LANGUAGES

Persian - Native | English - Fluent | Czech - Intermediate